

The Place Where No One Could See

Today was different.

Not because life became harder.

Not because something broke.

But because for the first time in a long while

my heart became heavier than the version of me I had created to carry it.

My eyes stood ready to surrender.

I could feel the tears gathering,
pressing against years of restraint

yet somehow...

I could not cry.

So I left my room.

I walked without purpose.

Not searching for answers.

Not searching for peace.

Only searching for a place
where nobody would see me become human.

A place where I could stop performing strength.

And when I found that place

I sat.

For almost two hours

I cried.

Silently.

No sound.

No shaking.

No dramatic collapse.

Only tears falling one after another
as though even my sorrow had learned
to apologize for existing.

I wanted to cry louder.

I wanted my chest to split open
and release every grief I had imprisoned inside myself.

But I could not.

Because somewhere in this endless pursuit of becoming strong

I forgot how to break.

And suddenly a thought struck me

When did strength become this lonely?

When did maturity begin demanding the sacrifice of feelings?

When did I start believing
that surviving means never being seen struggling?

People come to me and say

"You are strong."

"You always handle everything."

"I wish I could be like you."

And each time they said those words

I smiled.

Not because they were true.

But because correcting them felt harder.

How could I tell them

that strength and silence are not the same thing?

That sometimes the strongest people are simply those
who learned nobody is coming to carry them.

And then another thought came

What is the point of having so many people around
if my heart still searches for empty places to cry?

What is friendship
if my sadness still feels like confidential information?

I wanted someone beside me.

Not someone to fix me.

Not someone to advise me.

Just someone who could sit there and say

"You do not need to explain."

But immediately another voice answered

No.

Do not let them see.

Your weakest moments become other people's stories.

Do not lose your face.

Do not lose the image.

And so

even while breaking

I protected the performance.

Then while sitting there

I saw something.

A tiny flickering insect.

It would glow for a brief moment

then disappear.

Glow.

Darkness.

Glow.

Darkness.

And for reasons I cannot explain

I saw myself.

Because I spent years trying to become light in everyone else's life

that I never realized
my own had quietly gone dark.

How tragic

to become everyone's sunrise
and return home every night to your own eclipse.

And then

I thought of God.

All those nights I looked upward and asked—

"Why did You not give me what I wanted?"

But today

for the first time

another question appeared.

Did I blame heaven
for wars I was fighting inside myself?

Did I mistake unanswered prayers
for abandonment?

Or was I simply too frightened of loss
to trust the road I was given?

I kept crying.

But even then

I could not completely let go.

Because another thought remained

People think I am strong.

People make me their example.

People come to me when they break.

So what right do I have

to collapse?

And perhaps that was the saddest realization of all.

Not that I had no one.

But that I had convinced myself
I must survive alone.

So eventually

I stood up.

Wiped my tears.

Adjusted my face.

Put on that old familiar smile

the one everyone recognizes.

And returned.

Returned to my room.

Returned to myself.

Or at least

to the version of myself that still knows how to laugh.

Now I sit here writing this.

Smiling.

Acting normal.

And yet

one eye betrayed me.

One final tear escaped
and rolled quietly down my cheek

as if reminding me

that beneath all this composure,

beneath this ambition,

beneath this illusion of strength

there still exists someone
who is tired.

Someone who misses being held.

Someone who just wants

for once

a place where they can cry loudly...

and not be afraid
that someone will call it weakness.

So I hid the tears.

And let the world keep my smile.